



Read When the Queue Is Empty

Auditing the Motor-Pool Desk's Booking-Deposit Tier Against Its Own Written Risk Rubric

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The problem

The motor-pool desk sets a booking's deposit tier from a written risk rubric — incident history, distance, vehicle class. Whether the tier a driver is actually charged still tracks that rubric once a queue forms at the key board is untested.

Research questions

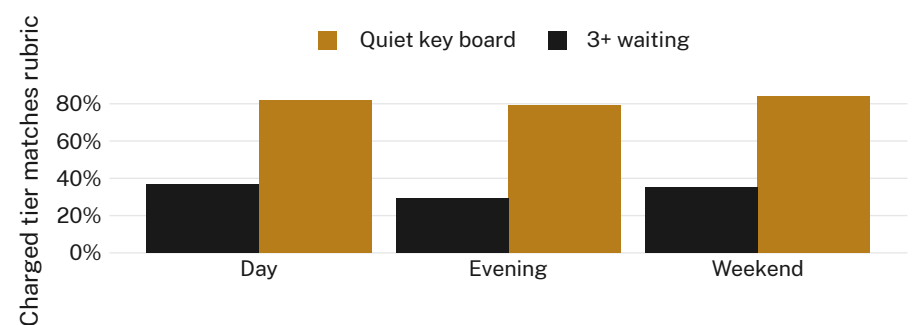
- Reconstruct each booking's rubric-predicted tier from its risk factors
- Compare the predicted tier against the tier the desk charged
- Test whether key-board queue length predicts the mismatch

Study design

- n = 1,140 pool-vehicle bookings · 14-week semester · rubric recomputed retrospectively
- 11 semi-structured staff interviews, day / evening / weekend shifts, thematic coding
- Queue length at hand-over logged from the desk's own sign-out sheet

What we found

Charged-tier agreement with the rubric is high while the key board is quiet and falls sharply once a queue forms, consistent across all three shift types. Staff report weighing queue length over the rubric's listed risk factors once pressure builds.



Charged-tier agreement with the written rubric averages 82% under a quiet key board and 34% once three or more drivers are waiting, holding across all three shift types (n = 1,140 pool-vehicle bookings, Semester 1 2026).

Implications

The rubric reads as a fallback consulted when there's time to check it, not a default applied at the counter. Under pressure the charged tier drifts toward the fastest-issued option regardless of what a driver's incident history would predict, and the desk's own monthly summary reports only the rubric's intended distribution, never the charged one. Next: testing whether pre-computing the tier at booking time, before the driver reaches the desk, closes the gap.

References

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Interview data de-identified prior to coding; no licence or incident details retained beyond the audit window.

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